

Lesson 17

Persuasive Selling



Warm-up

1. Can you think of a time when you were persuaded to buy something? What factors made you decide to buy this item?
2. What are some common objections you encounter, and how do you respond to them?





Role-Play

Scenario: Bryan (salesperson) attended an Expo and met a potential customer, James.

Role-Play Dialogue

Bryan: Hi, are you looking for a way to boost your team's productivity?

James: Yes, we've been struggling to stay organized.

Bryan: Our product, TaskMaster, can help. **This will help you by** streamlining workflows and enhancing collaboration.

James: That sounds interesting. How does it work?

Bryan: It's easy to use and integrates with your existing tools. Plus, **this will help you increase** productivity by 25% based on our customers' feedback.

James: That's impressive. What's the cost?

Bryan: **Compared to our competitors**, we offer a very competitive pricing plan, and I'd be happy to provide a customized quote. Would you like to see the demo?

Role-Play Analysis

Answer the following questions:

1. What is the customer's pain point?
2. What solution did Bryan confidently propose?
3. What are the key benefits of the product that Bryan presented to the customer?
4. Did Bryan utilize social proof to convincingly persuade the customer? Explain.
5. What decisive action did Bryan take to encourage the customer to move forward?



Vocabulary

1. **This will help you by...** – used to explain how a product or service will benefit the customer

Example:

- ***This will help you by*** reducing the costs and improving efficiency.

2. **A key advantage is...** – used to highlight a significant benefit or unique feature that sets the product apart from others

Example:

- ***A key advantage of*** our software is its user-friendly interface, making it easy for anyone to use.

3. **Our product stands out because...** – used to highlight the unique features, benefits, or value proposition that differentiate your product from others in the market

Example:

- ***Our product stands out because*** it offers real-time data analytics, enabling businesses to make informed decisions.

4. **This will help you increase...** – used to highlight the specific benefits and results that the customer can expect from using the product

Example:

- ***This will help you increase*** your sales revenue by up to 20%.

5. **Compared to competitors, we...** – used to identify unique selling points

Example:

- ***Compared to our competitors, we*** have a more competitive pricing strategy.



Practice

1. Fill in the blanks with the correct words to complete the sentences. You may refer to the 'Key Vocabulary' section for the answer.

1. To gain a _____ in the market, our sales team needs to emphasize the unique features of our product.
2. Our product can help businesses increase efficiency and reduce costs, providing a significant _____.
3. The _____ of our new smartphone is its advanced camera capabilities which set it apart from other models on the market.
4. Our product's ability to streamline processes and increase productivity is a _____ for businesses to adopt our solution.
5. Our premium customer service provides personalized support and ensures quick resolution of any issues, adding _____ to our product offering.

2. Choose a partner and practice role-playing the given dialogue to become comfortable with conversational patterns and expressions in persuasive selling.

Bryan: Our software is designed to help e-commerce businesses like yours streamline their marketing operations. **This will help you by** saving time and resources which can be redirected to more strategic initiatives.

James: That sounds interesting. How does your software compare to others on the market?

Bryan: **A key advantage is** our software's ability to integrate with multiple platforms, providing a seamless user experience. **Our product stands out because** of its scalability and flexibility, which can adapt to the changing needs of your business.

James: I see. How will this help us increase our sales?

Bryan: **This will help you increase** your sales by providing personalized product recommendations to customers, based on their browsing and purchasing history.



Production

A. UNDERSTANDING PERSUASIVE SELLING

1. What is persuasive selling and how is it different from traditional selling?
2. How do you research and understand the client's needs before a sales meeting?
3. How do you build rapport and trust with potential customers?
4. How do you identify a customer's pain points?
5. What strategies do you use to overcome objections and close the sale?

B. DISCUSSION: SAVING A STRUGGLING PRODUCT

Work in pairs or small groups on a brief case study about a struggling product.
Your task is to:

- Choose a product and **analyze** the situation.
- Discuss and agree on **how to reposition the product**:
 - *What **value** does this product still offer?*
 - *How can we **differentiate** it from competitors?*
 - *Who could be a new **target market**?*
 - *What is a **compelling reason** to buy it now?*
 - *How can we explain the **ROI** (return on investment) to business buyers or partners?*
- Prepare **2–3 persuasive messages** to pitch the revised product.
- Presents your new persuasive selling points. Keep it concise and focused.

List of products:

Product names	Descriptions	Problems
1. CubeGarden	A desktop mini herb garden for office workers.	The maintenance is tricky, and some users complain about the smell.
2. TrackSocks	Smart socks that track your walking posture and steps.	Expensive and users can't feel the benefit immediately.
3. GlareBlock Glasses	Glasses that reduce screen glare and blue light.	Users say they're unattractive and overpriced.
4. HushChair	A high-walled, noise-reducing chair for open-plan offices.	Bulky and takes up too much space in modern offices.
5. SleepPods	Noise-cancelling sleep hoods you wear at your desk.	Many people see them as unprofessional or antisocial in the workplace.

Discussion:

- What was the biggest challenge in trying to sell or reposition your product?
- Which persuasive phrase or vocabulary word did your group use most effectively? Why do you think it worked well?
- Can you think of a real product you've seen that was once unpopular but became successful through good selling or marketing? What was the key selling point?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
Value	the importance, worth, or usefulness of a product or service	<i>Our sales team is trained to communicate the value of our solutions effectively, addressing customers' specific pain points.</i>
Differentiation	used to clearly communicate what sets product apart	<i>The differentiation of our product lies in its ability to solve a specific problem that other products can't.</i>
Competitive edge	used to highlight the unique benefits or features of a product or service	<i>Developing a specialized skill set can give you a competitive edge in the job market.</i>
ROI	return on investment	<i>We expect a significant ROI from investing in employee training, leading to improved productivity and retention.</i>
Selling point	a key advantage that sets the product or service apart from others in the market	<i>The unique design of our product is a strong selling point that grabs attention and generates interest.</i>
Compelling reason	used to motivate and persuade the audience to take action	<i>Having a stable future for my family is a compelling reason for me to pursue this new career opportunity.</i>